

the user page on the demo site. It offers a user a history of the lending habit – books lent and returned, fines paid, etc. – and a search function that can track a book across different libraries – and, even better, place a hold request in case the book is tracked down.

Evergreen is comprised of three parts. The first part is a server, where all the data is stored. This being a web service, the application has to be installed on a web server before it can be used. Unfortunately, there are no demo sites to test the server.

The second part is a “Staff Client”. This is an application used by library staff to record details of lendable items, and track patron activities. The client needs to be connected to the server for which the URL of the client and a username and password are required. The client is available in binary (or EXE) form for Windows, but has to be compiled from source for Linux. The client is minimalist, but offers the basic functions of cataloguing new books, verifying the status of existing books and managing patron relationships. Pros would be better able to appreciate the finer aspects of the options under the different menus in the Staff client. The staff client also has an offline mode that allows recording transactions without being connected to the server, which can be synchronised later after the connection is established.

The third part is the public interface. The demo site, mentioned previously, is in fact the public interface. This page can be accessed with any browser.

NewGenLib (www.verussolutions.biz/web/) is another open source application in the same category. It has been created by an Indian organisation, and is in use in major libraries in India, as culled from the web site.

Additional resources

Rosegarden (<http://www.rosegardenmusic.com/>) and Ardour (<http://www.ardour.org>) are two open source audio editing tools that are not available under Windows. A long list of more audio applications is available here <http://www.opensound.com/ossapps.html>